

Team 10 Sprint 1

1. Project Title:

Campus Dining Meal Plan Initiative

2. Business Objective

The main goal of our project is to find out if students would be more interested in buying a campus meal plan if it was more flexible and gave them better value for their money. From our interviews, we found that students have very different budgets and eating habits. Some students were only comfortable spending around \$400–\$600 per semester, while a student who lives on campus was comfortable spending around \$1,200–\$1,500 because they would use the plan almost every day. We also found that students care about getting their money's worth. They mentioned things like discounts, having different food choices, being able to eat at different locations, and not losing money they already paid for. Because of this, we want to create a meal-plan idea that could work for more students and possibly encourage them to spend more of their food budget on campus.

3. Scope Boundary

In Scope -

For this project, we will focus on:

- Looking at different types of meal plans, including a dollar balance and a set number of meals.
- Finding a meal-plan option that can work for students who eat on campus often and students who do not.
- Looking into allowing unused meal-plan money or meals to roll over instead of expiring.
- Comparing monthly payments with paying for the whole semester at once.
- Looking at whether students should be able to use their meal plan at different dining locations on campus.
- Considering food variety, healthy choices, allergies, and dietary information.
- Getting more student feedback to see if our final idea actually solves the problems we found.

These choices come directly from our interviews. For example, some students preferred a dollar balance because they do not spend the same amount every day, while other students preferred having a set number of meals because it would be easier to keep track of.

Out of Scope -

For now, our project will not include:

- Building a complete meal-plan app or website.
- Launching a new meal plan at UTEP.
- Changing tuition or other university fees.
- Renovating dining halls.
- Changing university financial policies.
- Guaranteeing that certain restaurants will accept the meal plan.
- Building the actual payment system.
- Making changes to existing university technology.

Our goal right now is to research and validates the idea, not to build the entire system.

Deferred

There are also ideas that we may look at later if our research shows that they are needed. These include:

- Choose the exact prices for each meal plan.
- Connecting the meal plan to existing UTEP payment or ID systems.
- Adding more campus or off-campus restaurants.
- Building an actual mobile app or website.
- Add personalized meal plans.
- Creating tools for dining staff to manage the plans.
- Launching the meal plan across campus.

We are putting these ideas off until later because we first need more evidence that students want the main idea. This follows the class guidance that the charter should stay high level, and that scope should come from validated problems instead of guesses.

4. Assumptions

There are still some things that our team does not know for sure. These are our current assumptions:

- We assume UTEP could offer different types of meal plans.
- We assume the current campus system could support a dollar balance, meal count, or a combination of both.
- We assume unused money or meals could possibly roll over to another semester.
- We assume monthly payments could be an option.
- We assume other students will have some of the same concerns as the students we interviewed.

- We assume multiple dining locations could participate in the same meal plan.
- We assume the meal plan could be priced low enough for students while still making sense financially.
- We assume students may eat on campus more often if they feel like the meal plan gives them better value.

We understand that these are not proven facts. Part of our project will be checking these assumptions instead of treating them as true. This is important because our class notes explain that an assumption is something that has not been verified and can become a project risk if it is wrong.

5. Stakeholder Register

Stakeholder	Why They Are Involved	Influence
Students	They are the main users of the meal plan and will tell us what works and what does not.	High
Commuter Students	They may not eat on campus every day, so they need a plan that does not waste their money.	High
Students Living on Campus	They are more likely to eat on campus often and may need a larger meal plan.	High
Graduate Students	Their schedules may be different, so they may want more flexible ways to spend their balance.	Medium
Campus Dining Administration	They would need to decide whether the meal plan could actually work financially and operationally.	High
UTEP Administration	They would need to approve major policy or payment changes.	High
Dining Locations/Vendors	They would be involved if the meal plan could be used at their locations.	Medium
Our Project Team	We are responsible for the research, planning, documentation, and validation of the project.	High
Project Manager	The project manager keeps the team organized and makes sure we stay within our scope.	High

Our interviews included several different types of students, such as commuters, graduate students, students living on campus, juniors, and seniors, which helped us see that different student groups may have different needs.

6. Success Criteria

We will consider this stage of the project successful if:

- At least 80% of the students in our next round of interviews like the idea of allowing unused meal-plan money or meals to roll over.
- At least 70% of the students we ask to believe our proposed meal plan would give them better value or flexibility than a single fixed plan.
- We come up with at least two meal-plan options that work for students with different eating habits.
- Our final idea clearly explains whether students would pay monthly or all at once.
- Our final idea clearly explains what happens to unused money or meals.
- The plan explains where students would be able to use their meal-plan money.
- Every major part of our final idea is supported by something we learned from our interviews or later research instead of something we just assumed.

Rollover is especially important because it was one of the strongest patterns in our interviews. Students repeatedly said that they did not want money or meals they already paid for to disappear.